



CinemaDNG

What is CinemaDNG?

Adobe Systems announced an initiative for defining an open-file format for digital cinema files and called it CinemaDNG. DNG (Digital Negative) is aimed at delivering to the video arena what RAW did for still imagery.

Who would be working on it?

The coalition of industry entities like cinema camera manufacturers (Panavision, Silicon Imaging, Dalsa, Weisscam and ARRI), software vendors (Iridas and The Foundry) and codec provider CineFORM would be working together for defining and publicly documenting the open-file format—CinemaDNG.

Why is it necessary?

Digital cinema requires dealing with a variety of file formats, which needs to be handled by different hardware and applications. With CinemaDNG, a common platform is possible, thereby easing most hassles such as compatibility and archiving.

When will it be finalised?

No specific time frame has been announced, since the initiative is being carried in coalition with camera manufacturers and other industry players.

How will it be beneficial?

Film makers can have a robust format for archiving with the highest quality source in open standards file formats. Manufacturers on the other hand, will enjoy the elimination of developmental costs for proprietary formats and conversion tools.

Which segment will it directly affect?

As a whole, the major beneficiaries of this open format will be the film-making fraternity. The open file format will directly affect prominent film-makers, since the hardware supporting CinemaDNG would yield significantly superior video quality.

and automated mail, the presence of well-known and starry profiles no longer appeal to users.

YOU PROMISED ME A LAPTOP!

OLPC Leadership Parts Ways

The much hyped One Laptop Per Child project, which was aimed at producing a laptop around the psychological \$100 figure, is in peril, again. Two of its key promoters—Nicholas Negroponte and Walter Bender—seem to have had their little battles with each other, which seems to be resulting in bigger battles. Although the project is the brainchild of Negroponte, his longtime MIT colleague Bender took care of the software deployment and content for the XO laptop which was meant to be an educational tool.

Bender wants to continue efforts to develop its dedicated Sugar software, and get it to work in a Linux environment, while on the other hand, Negroponte seems to be anticipating growth for his project. He is eager to have a dual boot option in the XO to accommodate a scaled down version of Windows, which Microsoft has been targeting for a very long time.

Sugar uses icons and other graphical features as an interface. However, it avoids Window's formats and is not compatible with its files. The latest news is that Bender has quit the OLPC project. This comes as disappointment to the open source proponents who supported the OLPC movement in its initial days. In an official statement, OLPC

spokesman George Snell said "Bender will not be replaced". He also added that the position of President of software and content has been eliminated.

EXPENSIVE BUY

Ballmer Says XP Could Stay

Microsoft, when they launched their latest OS—Vista, had planned to shelf the earlier XP from sales on June 30, 2008. However, Steve Ballmer, CEO—Microsoft clarified, that XP sales could continue, if customers intended at using them. He went on to add that as of now, there was no such indication from customers.

Earlier, Microsoft had set a deadline to remove Windows XP from its umbrella of products from retail sales around June 30. This was in the wake of high Vista sales figures.

It is definitely a subject of interest why customers have not hinted at a demand for XP over Vista, despite the comparisons, reviews and reports of XP and Vista. "XP will hit an end-of-life. We have announced one. If customer feedback varies

we can always wake up smarter but right now we have a plan for end-of-life for new XP shipments," Ballmer said in a news conference.

APPLE ALSO WANTS TO BUY

Objection To Apple's Acquisition

Steve Jobs led Apple Inc., recently acquired chipmaker PA Semi. However, there is now growing concern over this move, with a probable objection from the US Department of Defense. The reason—a high performance, low cost and power efficient CPU designed by PA Semi is used in around 10 defence systems, with around 70,000 chips to be used across systems over the next 10 years.

As Jobs says, Apple acquired the company for the talent rather than the products. Further to the deal, Jobs also reiterated that Apple had close relations with Intel and that they looked forward to taking this relationship further. Nevertheless, in an industry such as defence, it is companies like Lockheed Martin and Raytheon that would decide the course of any merger or acquisition that could probably take place, because as a direct consequence of such deals, procurement of spare parts and other materials are affected, which could hamper multi-million dollar deals!

This deal would surely be under the scanner of many defence companies, at least the ones that used to source their chips from PA Semi. It all depends on how Apple handles the industry concerns - this time the department of defence and not consumers! ■

